

Kerala Assembly Elections 2026: Comeback, continuity or change? Poonjar faces a three-way test

P.C. George, the seven-time MLA now representing the NDA, is hopeful of putting behind him the backlash he got from the Muslim community in 2021; incumbent MLA Sebastian Kulathungal of the LDF is pitching stability and steady governance; UDF’s M.J. Sebastian is betting big on anti-incumbency

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The otherwise smooth run along the Kottayam-Kumily road grinds into a choke point at Mundakkayam, the gateway to the high ranges and today a stage for high voltage politics. A few hundred metres in, a saffron convoy cuts through the traffic. At its helm, standing tall in an open-roofed vehicle is P.C. George, waving and smiling.

Now the Bharatiya Janata Party’s face in Poonjar, Kottayam’s easternmost Assembly constituency, the seven-time legislator is no stranger to political combat. Every 200 metres, the convoy halts. Workers gather and raise slogans, and Mr. George delivers quick-fire speeches. “I am banking on development, the work I have done across Poonjar,” he declares, his voice cutting through the summer haze.

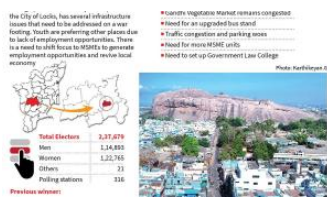
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